

Word family: ****sting / stings / stung / stinging / stinger****

****Base word:** sting**

****Part of speech:** mainly ****verb**** and ****noun******

****Related forms:****

* ****sting**** (v.) — 刺；叮；灼痛；刺痛；使難受

* ****sting**** (n.) — 刺傷；叮咬；刺痛；令人難受之處

* ****stung**** (past / past participle) — sting 的過去式及過去分詞

* ****stinging**** (adj.) — 刺痛的；尖銳傷人的；猛烈的

* ****stinger**** (n.) — 螫針；刺人的器官；某些其他專門用法

****Useful expressions / extensions:****

* ****be stung by a bee****

* ****sting someone****

* ****eyes sting****

* ****skin stings****

* ****sting with pain****

* ****words sting****

* ****criticism stings****

* ****the sting of rejection****

* ****take the sting out of****

* ****stinging criticism****

* ****stinging remark****

* ****stinging pain****

* ****bee sting****

* ****insect sting****

* ****stinger****

Meaning in this passage

> His words ****stung**** more than I expected, partly because I knew I had done my job, and partly because he said it so publicly.

Here, ****stung**** is figurative.

It means:

****hurt me emotionally in a sudden, sharp way — 令我感到刺痛；令我難受；刺傷了我的感受****

Kevin's words did not physically sting the speaker. They caused a sharp emotional hurt because the accusation was unfair and public.

****中文翻譯：****

他那番話比我想像中更****刺耳 / 更令我難受****，一方面是因為我明明有做好自己的事，另一方面是因為他是在大家面前這樣說。

So here:

**words sting = 說話像被針刺一樣，突然而尖銳地傷害人的感受**

1. **sting (昆蟲等叮 / 螫) — 叮 ; 螫**

The core literal sense.

Practice 1

> A bee ****stung me**** on the hand.

一隻蜜蜂在我的手上****螫了我一下****。

Practice 2

> Be careful—the insect can ****sting****.

小心，那種昆蟲會****螫人****。

Practice 3

> She was ****stung by a wasp****.

她被黃蜂****螫了****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = 昆蟲、海洋生物等用螫針或有毒器官刺傷人或動物****

2. **be stung by something — 被.....螫傷**

Practice 1

> He was ****stung by a bee****.

他被蜜蜂****螫傷****。

Practice 2

> Several swimmers were ****stung by jellyfish****.

幾名泳客被水母****螫傷****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be stung by X = 被具有螫刺或刺激性器官的動物刺傷****

3. ****sting (植物等刺痛皮膚) — 刺痛 ; 刺激****

Practice 1

> The nettles ****stung my legs****.

蕁麻令我的腿****刺痛****。

Practice 2

> Some plants can ****sting your skin****.

有些植物會令皮膚產生****刺痛感****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = 接觸某種植物或物質後，使皮膚產生尖銳的灼痛感****

4. ****sting (傷口 / 皮膚刺痛) — 刺痛 ; 灼痛****

The subject can be the affected body part or injury.

Practice 1

> The cut ****stings**** when I wash it.

這個傷口洗水時會****刺痛****。

Practice 2

> My skin ****stung**** after I applied the cream.

我塗了乳霜後皮膚感到****刺痛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = 產生短促、尖銳或灼熱的疼痛感****

5. ****eyes sting — 眼睛刺痛****

Practice 1

> The smoke made my eyes ****sting****.

煙霧令我的眼睛****刺痛****。

Practice 2

> My eyes were ****stinging**** from the chlorine.

氯氣令我的眼睛一直****刺痛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****eyes sting = 眼睛受到煙霧、化學物或其他刺激而產生刺痛感****

6. ****sting with pain — 痛得刺痛****

Practice 1

> His hand ****stung with pain****.

他的手****一陣刺痛****。

Practice 2

> The wound ****stung sharply****.

傷口傳來一陣****尖銳刺痛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting with pain = 感受到尖銳、灼熱而突然的疼痛****

7. ****sting (說話使人心裏刺痛) — 刺傷感受 ; 令人氣難受****

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> His words ****stung**** more than I expected.

他的說話比我想像中更****令我難受 / 刺痛了我的感受****。

Practice 2

> Her comment really ****stung****.

她那句話真的很****傷人****。

Practice 3

> The accusation ****stung**** because it was completely unfair.

那項指責因為完全不公平，所以特別****令人難受****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = figurative: 以突然而尖銳的方式傷害某人的感受、自尊或情緒****

8. ****words / comments / remarks sting — 說話刺痛人心****

Practice 1

> His harsh words ****stung****.

他的尖銳說話****刺痛了人心****。

Practice 2

> The remark ****stung****, even though she tried not to show it.

那句話很****傷人****，雖然她努力沒有表現出來。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****words sting = 說話令人突然感到受傷、尷尬或難受****

9. ****criticism stings — 批評令人難受****

Practice 1

> The criticism ****stung****, but some of it was fair.

那些批評很****刺耳 / 令人難受****，但部分也有道理。

Practice 2

> Public criticism can ****sting more deeply****.

公開批評有時會****更加傷人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****criticism stings = 批評令人感到尖銳的情緒痛楚****

10. ****sting (noun : 昆蟲螫傷) — 螫傷 ; 叮傷****

Practice 1

> I got a bee ****sting**** on my arm.

我的手臂被蜜蜂****螫了一下****。

Practice 2

> The ****sting**** became swollen.

****螫傷的位置****腫了起來。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = 昆蟲或其他生物螫刺造成的傷口或事件****

11. ****bee sting / insect sting — 蜜蜂螫傷 / 昆蟲叮螫****

Practice 1

> A ****bee sting**** can be painful.

****蜜蜂螫傷****可能很痛。

Practice 2

> He developed swelling around the ****insect sting****.

他在****昆蟲叮螫處****附近出現腫脹。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X sting = 被某種昆蟲或動物螫刺造成的傷害****

12. ****sting (noun : 刺痛感) — 刺痛 ; 灼痛****

Practice 1

> I felt a sharp ****sting**** in my finger.

我的手指感到一陣尖銳的****刺痛****。

Practice 2

> The medicine caused a slight ****sting****.

藥物帶來一點****刺痛感****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a sting = 一陣短促而尖銳的疼痛或灼熱感****

13. ****the sting of something —帶來的刺痛 / 難受****

A major figurative noun construction.

Practice 1

> He still felt the ****sting of rejection****.

他仍然感受到被拒絕帶來的****難受 / 刺痛****。

Practice 2

> Time softened the ****sting of the criticism****.

時間慢慢減輕了那次批評帶來的****刺痛感****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the sting of X = X 所造成的強烈、尖銳情緒痛楚****

14. ****the sting of rejection / defeat / criticism — 被拒 / 失敗 / 批評的痛楚****

Practice 1

> She remembered the ****sting of defeat****.

她仍記得失敗所帶來的****刺痛感****。

Practice 2

> The apology reduced the ****sting of his words****.

那次道歉減輕了他那番話造成的****傷害****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting of X = 某種不愉快經歷留下的尖銳情緒痛楚****

15. ****take the sting out of something — 減輕.....的痛楚 / 打擊****

A very useful idiom.

Practice 1

> His apology ****took some of the sting out of**** the criticism.

他的道歉****減輕了那次批評帶來的傷害****。

Practice 2

> The refund ****took the sting out of**** the bad experience.

退款多少****減輕了那次糟糕經歷帶來的不快****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****take the sting out of X = 減輕 X 所造成的痛苦、失望或難受****

16. ****stinging (刺痛的 ; 灼痛的) — 刺痛的****

Practice 1

> I felt a **stinging pain** in my eye.

我的眼睛感到一陣**刺痛**。

Practice 2

> The cut caused a **stinging sensation**.

傷口帶來**刺痛感**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stinging = causing or involving a sharp, burning pain

17. **stinging criticism — 尖銳猛烈的批評**

A major figurative adjective sense.

Practice 1

> The report contained **stinging criticism** of the decision.

報告對該決定作出**尖銳猛烈的批評**。

Practice 2

> She delivered a **stinging criticism** of his behaviour.

她對他的行為作出了**毫不留情的批評**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stinging criticism = 尖銳、強烈而令人難受的批評

18. **stinging remark — 尖酸 / 傷人的說話**

Practice 1

> He made a **stinging remark** about my work.

他對我的工作說了一句很**尖酸傷人的話**。

Practice 2

> Her **stinging comment** silenced the room.

她那句**尖銳傷人的評論**令全場安靜下來。

MCQ-ready definition:

stinging remark = 尖銳而容易傷害別人感受的說話

19. **stinger** (螫針) — 螫針

Practice 1

> A bee leaves its **stinger** in the skin in some circumstances.

蜜蜂在某些情況下會把**螫針**留在皮膚中。

Practice 2

> The insect raised its **stinger**.

昆蟲抬起了它的**螫針**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stinger = 昆蟲或某些動物用來螫刺的尖銳器官

20. **sting** (警方誘捕行動) — 誘捕行動；釣魚式執法行動

A major separate noun sense.

Practice 1

> Police arrested several suspects in an undercover **sting**.

警方在一次秘密**誘捕行動**中拘捕數名疑犯。

Practice 2

> The officers set up a **sting operation**.

警員設下了一次**誘捕行動**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****sting = 執法人員暗中設局，以誘使疑犯暴露犯罪行為並進行拘捕的行動****

21. ****sting operation — 秘密誘捕行動****

Practice 1

> The arrests followed a six-month ****sting operation****.

拘捕行動是在一場為期六個月的****秘密誘捕行動****後進行。

Practice 2

> An undercover officer took part in the ****sting operation****.

一名臥底警員參與了這次****誘捕行動****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting operation = 執法部門利用臥底或誘餌蒐集犯罪證據的秘密行動****

22. ****sting (欺騙 / 騙局 , informal) — 騙局 ; 詐騙****

Less central, but established.

Practice 1

> The whole deal turned out to be a ****sting****.

整宗交易最後發現是一個****騙局****。

Practice 2

> He suspected they were setting up some kind of ****sting****.

他懷疑對方正在設一個某種****圈套 / 騙局****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sting = informal: 一個設局欺騙或誘使某人上當的安排****

Important distinction 1: ****sting vs bite****

****sting****

uses a stinger or venom-delivering structure.

****bite****

uses teeth, jaws, or mouthparts.

> a bee stings

> a dog bites

Some insects may bite rather than sting.

Important distinction 2: ****sting vs prick****

****prick****

a small sharp object pierces the skin.

****sting****

often includes burning/sharp pain and may involve venom or chemical irritation.

> prick your finger with a needle

> 被針刺一下手指

> be stung by a bee

> 被蜜蜂螫

Important distinction 3: ****sting vs hurt****

****hurt****

very broad physical or emotional pain.

****sting****

suggests pain that is ****sharp, sudden, and piercing****.

This is why it works so well figuratively:

> His words hurt.

他的話傷害了我。

> His words stung.

他的話**像刺了一下一樣傷人**。

****Stung**** is more vivid.

Important distinction 4: ****sting vs offend****

****offend****

make someone feel insulted or displeased.

****sting****

focuses on the emotional pain caused.

A comment can sting without technically being offensive.

Important distinction 5: ****sting vs upset****

****upset****

broad emotional distress.

****sting****

a sharper, more sudden emotional wound.

In your passage:

> Kevin's words ****stung****

> = the words themselves hit sharply.

> the speaker was ****upset****

> = the broader emotional state afterward.

Important distinction 6: ****sting vs irritate****

sting

usually a sharp burning pain.

irritate

cause discomfort, inflammation, or annoyance more generally.

> Smoke irritated my eyes.

煙霧刺激眼睛。

> My eyes stung.

我的眼睛刺痛。

One describes the cause; the other often describes the sensation.

Important distinction 7: **sting as verb vs sting as noun**

Verb

> The cut stings.

傷口很刺痛。

Noun

> I felt a sting.

我感到一陣刺痛。

Important distinction 8: **stinging words vs words that sting**

stinging words/comments

describes the words themselves as sharp/hurtful.

the words stung

describes their effect on the listener.

Important distinction 9: ****the sting of X****

This construction is usually figurative when X is abstract:

* ****sting of rejection****

* ****sting of defeat****

* ****sting of criticism****

It means:

****X 所帶來的尖銳情緒痛楚****

Important distinction 10: ****take the sting out of vs remove the problem****

****take the sting out of****

does not necessarily remove the original problem.

It means:

****make its painful or unpleasant effect weaker****

An apology cannot undo Kevin's public accusation, but it can ****take some of the sting out of it****.

Important distinction 11: ****stinging criticism vs constructive criticism****

****stinging criticism****

sharp, severe, emotionally painful.

****constructive criticism****

intended to help improve something.

Criticism can be constructive without being stinging.

Important distinction 12: ****sting operation is lexicalized****

A police ****sting**** has nothing to do with literal insects.

The metaphor is of a trap that suddenly “gets” the target.

It should be learned as a distinct established sense:

****警方誘捕行動****

Family-extension note

****Sting**** develops very naturally from physical pain into emotional pain:

1. ****literal animal attack****

- * bee stings someone
- * bee sting
- * stinger

2. ****physical burning/sharp sensation****

- * wound stings
- * eyes sting
- * stinging pain

3. ****emotional hurt****

- * words sting
- * criticism stings

4. ****noun emotional pain****

- * sting of rejection
- * sting of defeat

5. ****sharp verbal attack****

- * stinging criticism
- * stinging remark

6. ****figurative trap****

- * police sting
- * sting operation

The central metaphor is especially transparent:

> **physical sharp pain → emotional sharp pain**

For your passage, this emotional extension is exactly what makes **stung** stronger and more expressive than plain **hurt**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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sting (animal)	叮；螫	venom/stinger attack
be stung by a bee	被蜜蜂螫	animal injury
sting the skin	令皮膚刺痛	physical irritation
wound stings	傷口刺痛	sharp pain
eyes sting	眼睛刺痛	burning sensation
sting with pain	一陣刺痛	sharp physical pain
words sting	說話刺痛人心	emotional hurt
criticism stings	批評令人難受	emotional pain
sting (noun: injury)	螫傷	physical injury
sting (noun: sensation)	刺痛感	sharp sensation
sting of rejection	被拒絕的刺痛	emotional aftermath
sting of defeat	失敗的痛楚	emotional pain
take the sting out of	減輕痛楚 / 打擊	soften impact
stinging pain	刺痛	physical pain
stinging criticism	尖銳猛烈的批評	harsh criticism
stinging remark	尖酸傷人的話	verbal hurt
stinger	螫針	stinging organ
sting (police)	誘捕行動	undercover trap
sting operation	秘密誘捕行動	law enforcement
sting (informal scheme)	騙局 / 圈套	deceptive setup

For your original sentence

> His words **stung more than I expected**, partly because I knew I had done my job, and partly because he said it so publicly.

Here:

stung = 他的指責像突然被刺了一下一樣，在情感上令我受到尖銳的傷害

It is not merely:

> **I didn't like what he said.**

It carries the stronger feeling:

> **his words hit a sensitive point and hurt immediately.**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他那番話比我想像中更**刺耳、更令我難受**，一方面是因為我明明有做好自己的事，另一方面是因為他是在大家面前這樣說。

For MCQ purposes, the cleanest exact meaning here is:

sting = 以突然而尖銳的方式傷害某人的感受